

demoed. Hence, even though tech-enthusiasts are all for the VR front going forward, the apprehension in general users is understandably an obstacle. That is where the role of the Cardboard comes in.

Essentially, Google Cardboard is a cardboard housing for a smartphone that consists of cardboard cut into precise shape, a lens kit, a pair of magnets or capacitive tape, a fastener (like Velcro), a rubber band and optionally an NFC tag. The schematics and specifications of all these have been shared openly by Google on their website and has been picked up by multiple manufacturers to create and sell Carboard-inspired products for as cheap as Rs.190/- on Amazon.in. This device has become a true conversion tool - people have walked into this with little or no trust in VR and walked out believing that this is the coolest tech they have tried in a while.

Keeping up with its open technology spirit, Google has released an open-SDK for development enthusiasts and we have already seen its impact in the wide array of apps and games available and in development for the Google Cardboard experience. We will be covering a few interesting ones later in this book.

Comparing the Cardboard to the Rift would not be fair. To begin with, the former uses your everyday smartphone to power the VR experience whereas the latter has the powerful innards of a high end gaming PC at its disposal. Think of Rift as your portal to dive inside your AAA console/PC games whereas the Cardboard as your pocket gateway into a VR-fied smartphone experience. We can say that with both the Rift and the Cardboard, the VR loop has been closed, and the world, with the knowledge that VR is about much more than just gaming, is now ready for both types of VR- the serious and the playful.

The entire story is not just made up of Head-Mounted Displays (HMDs). Better degrees of immersion are achieved by involving more senses and limbs. This point hasn't gone unnoticed in the VR race. Now that the play-ground seems to have a lot of players, let us have a look at few of the significant ones that are betting on much more along with HMDs.

Look Before you Leap!

In our everyday life, perhaps even in the way we sleep, our hands are perhaps the most significant body part that we use to interact with our surroundings. Although traditionally VR has been focussed on the sense of vision, motion detection has recently become a big aspect of interacting with the virtual reality. In 2008, David Holz, then a Ph.D student in